# Branding Numbers




Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

**Covers these lab items:** Branding numbers

## What it is used for

To apply approved identification numbers to livestock using the designated animal-branding procedure. To ensure identification is legible while minimizing pain, burns, and infection risk.

## Main parts

- Numbering irons or approved branding device
- Heat source or device control, depending on method
- Restraint equipment
- Cleaning and disinfection supplies
- Protective gloves and other PPE

## Before you start

1. Confirm the animal's identity, ownership authorization, and applicable identification rules.
2. Use branding only when legally permitted and approved by a veterinarian or trained livestock professional.
3. Ensure the animal can be safely restrained by trained handlers.
4. Inspect the equipment and prepare the approved cleaning supplies.
5. Confirm that the chosen method, number size, and placement are appropriate for the animal.

## How to use

1. Verify the assigned identification number before starting.
2. Prepare and restrain the animal using an approved humane procedure.
3. Prepare the branding device strictly according to its instructions and the approved method.
4. Apply the identification only at the approved site and for the specified contact time.
5. Release the animal safely and inspect the site for injury or abnormal reaction.
6. Provide aftercare according to veterinary guidance.
7. Record the identification and report any complication.

## ⚠ Safety

- Branding must be performed only by trained, authorized personnel.
- Never improvise with heated metal or apply excessive contact time.
- Use humane handling and avoid unnecessary distress.
- Follow veterinary guidance for pain management and wound care.
- Seek veterinary help for severe burns, bleeding, infection, or abnormal behaviour.

## Care & storage

- Clean and disinfect reusable equipment according to its instructions.
- Inspect the branding device for damage before storage.
- Keep records of identification and aftercare.
- Store equipment securely away from animals and children.

## Common mistakes to avoid

- Branding without confirming the assigned number.
- Using an unapproved method or location.
- Applying excessive heat or contact time.
- Ignoring wound care or signs of infection.

*Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.*



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